0201026/27 2&1 B.B.E.K.O
October 2026
ENGLISH LANGUAGE 2 & 1 **2 &1**
Essay and Objective
2 hours

Name.....

Index Number.....

BEST BRAIN EXAMINATIONS KONSORTIUM

GHANA

Special Private Mock Examinations for BECE Candidates

October 2026 — ENGLISH LANGUAGE **2&1** — 2 hour

ESSAY AND OBJECTIVE

Do **not** *open this booklet until you are told to do so. While you are waiting, read and observe the following instructions carefully. Write your* **name** *and* **index number** *in* **ink** *in the spaces provided above.*

This booklet consists of two papers. Answer Paper **2** *which comes first, in your answer booklet and Paper* **1** *on your Objective Test answer sheet. Paper* **2** *will last* **1** hour **15** minutes *after which the answer booklet will be collected. Do* **not** *start Paper* **1** *until you are told to do so. Paper* **1** *will last* **45** *minutes.*

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PAPER 2 1 hour 15 minutes

This Paper consists of **three** parts: **A, B and C.**
Answer **three** *questions in* **all;** **one** *question from* Part **A** *and* **all** *the questions in* Part **B** *and* Part **C.** *Answer all the questions in your answer booklet.*
Credit will be given for clarity of expression and orderly presentation of material.

PART A
WRITING
[30 marks]

Answer **one** *question* **only** *from this part.*
Your composition should be about **250** *words long.*

1. During a school excursion, you noticed that a historic site in your district was poorly maintained. Write a letter to the District Chief Executive explaining why the site should be protected and suggesting **two** ways to preserve it.

2. Your school has been selected to participate in a debate competition, and you have been chosen as the main speaker to speak on the motion, "The Basic School Curriculum Should Be Revised." Write a speech for or against the motion.

3. You spent your last holidays staying with a relative in a different town. Describe **three** main differences you noticed between life in that place and life in your own home town.

PART B
READING
[20 marks]

4. *Read the following passage carefully and answer* **all** *the questions which follow.*

'Life is going to be very difficult this year,' Abida said to herself as she set out from her house. She was going to her farm, but was not quite sure what she was going to do there. It had not rained for months and the crops on her farm were dying. She had almost decided not to go to the farm that morning, when it occurred to her that there was nothing for her to do at home either. 'If I go to the farm, at least I can bring home some firewood,' she thought, 'and maybe the pawpaw I saw on the tree last week may just be ripe. The children will love it if I bring it home.' She had hardly finished that sentence when, as if some evil spirit wanted to dampen her spirits, it occurred to her that if indeed that pawpaw was ripe, the birds must have got to it first. 'Too bad, if they have,' Abida shrugged her shoulders.

For three consecutive years the rains had failed to come at the right time; that is, at the time the farmers had learnt over the years to expect it to come. When it did come, it was so scanty; it hardly soaked into the topsoil. In Abida's grandmother's time, when virgin land was available near the village, the farmers practised shifting cultivation. Whenever their old farmlands became exhausted and too barren to produce abundant food, the farmers just cleared some more virgin land and started new farms. Now there was no virgin land, and Abida and the other farmers in the village had to make do with their old farmlands.

They had learnt all about fertilizers from Agricultural Extension Officers. They knew fertilizers could improve the soil and make it fertile again, but, said Abida to herself, the fertilizers

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had been of no use these past three years. Every farmer knows that crops need water to grow, but the rains had failed to come. Moreover, there was no water to irrigate the soil. The villagers were even lucky to have drinking water from a bore-hole that had been dug for them only the year before; for the river that flows by the village, and which, from time immemorial, had been the source of drinking water for the people of Domeabra village, had almost dried up.

The year before the bore-hole was dug, women and children had had to walk so many miles every morning looking for water that many young people left the village to seek their fortunes in the regional capital, leaving behind mostly the very young children and the old people. Abida had managed to persuade her two grown-up sons to stay on in the village for a while, and they were able to help her uproot the tree stumps on her biggest farm, so that she could have more land for her crops. That year their efforts did yield results, and Abida harvested enough food to be able to store some maize for the following year. Last year, however, the harvest was a disaster, and try as she did to economize, there just was not enough grain to feed the whole family. Out of worry, her sons joined the young men in the city, leaving Abida to manage as best as she could.

(a) Why was Abida hesitant to go to her farm that morning?

(b) Why were fertilizers of no use to the farmers during this period?

(c) When did many young people begin leaving the village?

(d) Which adjective best describes the present population of the village?

(e) **(i)** "Too bad, if they have." What does this expression refer to?

(ii) "When it did come.... ". What is being referred to in this expression?

(f) Explain in your own words the following expressions as used in the passage:

(i) *...dampen her spirits...*;

(ii) *shrugged her shoulders*;

(iii) *make do with*;

(iv) *from time immemorial;*

(v) *had hardly finished*

(vi) *try as she did*

(g) For **each** of the following words, give another word or phrase that means **the same** and can fit into the passage:

(i) quite;

(ii) thought;

(iii) scanty;

(iv) exhausted;

(v) barren;

(vi) abundant;

(vii) economize;

(viii) disaster.

(h) **(i)** In **two** sentences of not more than **ten** words **each**, summarise **two** effects of the poor rains on the people of Domeabra.

(ii) In **not** more than **eight** words, suggest a suitable title for the passage.

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PART C
LITERATURE
[10 marks]

Answer **all** *the questions in this part*

DIABO J.Y, ANKRAH A., OKRAH B. and ZANYO L. (COMP.): *The Beacon of Light.*

5. Read the following three extracts carefully and answer Questions **5**(a), **5**(b) and **5**(c).

PROSE: ***Calabash of Saha***

"It showed in the sunken eyes of Abidatu's little brother, who had fallen ill with cholera just last month. The memory of his frail body, wracked with pain, still haunted her. And now, as she looked at Abubakar, she knew that their project wasn't just about winning a competition – it was about saving lives.

(a) The literary device shown in the underlined expression is .....
(b) How would you describe Abidatu's character?
(c) What was the main purpose of the project?

Read the following extract carefully and answer Questions 5(d), 5(e) and 5(f).

DRAMA: ***Dawuni's Dream***

Dawuni: *(joyfully)* "Our land is reborn! Our people will thrive once more!"
Alheri: *(smiling)* "The ancestors have truly blessed us."
King Maker 1: *(impressed)* "Your Majesty, your leadership and faith have saved our kingdom."
Dawuni: *(humbly)* "It was not I alone, but the collective effort of our people and the guidance of the ancestors."

(d) What major event has just taken place before this extract?
(e) Which expression is an example of metaphor in the extract?
(f) What does King Maker 1's statement reveal about Dawuni's leadership?

Read the following extract carefully and answer Questions 5(g), 5(h), 5(i) and 5(j).

POETRY: ***Monday Breeze***

Blurring horns
Screaming voice
Running legs
Children settle in van
Mummy runs out and returns
Daddy yells

(g) What picture of Monday morning does the poem present?
(h) The words "Blurring horns" and "Screaming voice" appeal mainly to the sense of.....
(i) There is the theme of.....in the extract above.
(j) State the dominant literary device in the extract.

END OF ESSAY TEST

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Answer **all** *the questions.*

Each question is followed by **four** *options lettered* **A** *to* **D**. *Find the correct option for* **each** *question and shade* **in pencil** *on your answer sheet the space which bears the same letter as the option you have chosen. Give only* **one** *answer to* **each** *question. An example is given below.*

From the options **A** *to* **D**, *choose the one which* **most suitably completes** *the following sentence.*

I had better.....you about this issue.

A. saw
B. see
C. seen
D. seeing

The correct answer is see, *which is lettered* **B** *and therefore answer space* **B** *would be shaded.*

A [redacted] C D

Be sure you understand the instructions at the beginning of each section before you try to answer any of the questions that follow them.

Do **not** *spend too much time on a question. If you find a question difficult, leave it and go on to the next one, then come and try it again later.*

Use **pencil** *throughout. If you wish to change an answer, erase your first answer completely and shade the appropriate space for the new answer.*

Do all rough work in this question paper.

Now answer the following questions.

PART A
LEXIS AND STRUCTURE

SECTION A

Choose from the options **A** *to* **D**, *the one which* **most suitably completes** *each sentence.*

1. Much as the candidate.....to explain his actions, the panel refused to reconsider its decision.
A. tried
B. has tried
C. had been trying
D. would try

2. Not only.....late for the interview, but he also forgot to bring his certificates.
A. he arrived
B. did he arrive
C. he did arrive
D. had he arrived

3. Her work is never attractive, ...?
A. does she
B. doesn't it
C. is it
D. isn't it

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4. My father has.....friends who visit him on weekends.
   A. a little
   B. much
   C. a few
   D. few

5. People believe that the increasing number of road accidents.....a serious threat to public safety.
   A. pose
   B. are posing
   C. have posed
   D. poses

6. Gottfried hit him.....he broke her nose.
   A. very hard that
   B. not hard that
   C. so hard that
   D. too hard that

7. The committee has been discussing the new policy.....three days.
   A. since
   B. over
   C. by
   D. with

8. Asio is a.....
   A. tall, lady, elegant of twenty.
   B. elegant, tall, lady in twenty.
   C. lady, elegant, tall at twenty.
   D. tall, elegant lady of twenty.

9. I was surprised to learn that my father has never.....in even a stream before.
   A. swam
   B. swum
   C. swim
   D. swims

10. Nobody speaks vernacular in school these days, ...?
   A. will they
   B. do they
   C. don't they
   D. should they

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11. They quarrel during the night but they.....before day.
    A. set it over
    B. pass it over
    C. make it up
    D. put it off

12. You had better.....early otherwise you will miss the flight.
    A. to come
    B. came
    C. come
    D. to be coming

13. I bought the motorbike.....the advice of an expert in motorbikes.
    A. with
    B. on
    C. by
    D. at

Choose from the options A to D, the **correct passive speech** *for the sentence in Question* **14**.

14. The headmaster awarded the students their certificates.
    A. The students were awarded their certificates by the headmaster.
    B. The students are awarded their certificates by the headmaster.
    C. Their certificates have been awarded to the students by the headmaster.
    D. The students had been awarded their certificates by the headmaster.

Choose from the options A to D, the **correct reported form** *of the sentence in Question* **15.**

15. "I cannot attend the meeting today, but I will come tomorrow," Kojo told Ama.
    Kojo told Ama that he couldn't attend the meeting.....
    A. that day but would come the following day.
    B. today but would come tomorrow
    C. that day but will come tomorrow
    D. then but will come the next day

SECTION B

Choose from the options **A** *to* **D** *the one which is* **nearest in meaning** *to the underlined word in* **each** *sentence.*

16. The <u>incessant</u> laughter of the girls angered Mr. Davor so much that he punished the class.
    A. excited
    B. meaningless
    C. senseless
    D. unceasing

17. The detective <u>ultimately</u> arrested the criminal.
    A. soon
    B. eventually
    C. lately
    D. subsequently

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18. This statement sounds a bit puzzling.
    A. convincing
    B. confusing
    C. contradictory
    D. interesting

19. The work is likely to obstruct traffic on the main road.
    A. assist
    B. facilitate
    C. strengthen
    D. block

20. I don't want to complain about her lukewarm attitude to work again.
    A. unproductive
    B. hostile
    C. unconcerned
    D. truant

SECTION C

Choose from the options **A** *to* **D,** *the one that is* **most nearly opposite in meaning** *to the underlined word to fill the gap in each sentence.*

21. The topic was complex, but the summary made it.....
    A. complex
    B. simple
    C. obscure
    D. hidden

22. Rain was once sporadic, but it is now.....
    A. constant
    B. occasional
    C. irregular
    D. rare

23. He proved to be deceitful, while his friend remained.....
    A. candid
    B. dishonest
    C. crafty
    D. deceitful

24. One student was attentive, but the other was.....
    A. observant
    B. careless
    C. watchful
    D. vigilant

25. Her actions were inimical to the team, but his were.....
    A. damaging
    B. harmful
    C. hostile
    D. beneficial

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SECTION D

In **each** *of the following sentences, a group of words has been underlined. Choose from the options* **A** *to* **D**, *the one that* **best explains** *the underlined group of words.*

26. Since we don't have a plan, we will just have to play it by ear. This means we will .....
- **A.** follow strict rules
- **B.** improvise as things happen
- **C.** listen to instructions
- **D.** cancel the meeting

27. The new manager needed a few weeks to learn the ropes. This means he needed to .....
- **A.** buy new equipment
- **B.** tie the packages
- **C.** understand how to do the job
- **D.** train the new workers

28. After twenty years of playing football, the captain decided to hang up his boots. This means he decided to .....
- **A.** clean his sports gear
- **B.** change his shoes
- **C.** sign a new contract
- **D.** retire from playing

29. The candidates were on tenterhooks while waiting for the exam results. This means they were ....
- **A.** calm and relaxed
- **B.** anxious and nervous
- **C.** angry and violent
- **D.** happy and excited

30. Our plans to travel abroad fell through at the last minute. This means the plans .....
- **A.** were completed
- **B.** were delayed briefly
- **C.** succeeded smoothly
- **D.** failed to happen

SECTION E

In the following passage, the numbered gaps indicate missing words. Against **each** *number in the list below the passage are* **four** *options arranged in columns lettered* **A** *to* **D**. *For* **each** *numbered gap, choose from the options provided, the word that is* **most suitable.**

After months of rising costs, the local trade association took action to help small business owners stay afloat. However, experts warn that trying to —**31**— rising prices by cutting quality could backfire and drive customers away. To stay profitable, shop owners must carefully —**32**— their daily expenses without losing the trust of their buyers. Meanwhile, several store managers are working together to —**33**— their stock levels before the busy holiday season begins. Even with extra stock ready, owners must stay alert to —**34**— sudden transport delays that could leave their shelves empty. In the end, keeping a business strong depends on the owner's ability to —**35**— good customer service during tough times.

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	A	B	C	D
31.	break	fight	stop	tackle
32.	manage	direct	handle	check
33.	pack up	fill up	add up	build up
34.	handle	undergo	suffer	pass
35.	guard	hold	defend	maintain

PART B
ORAL LANGUAGE

[UNIT I]

Choose from the options **A** *to* **D**, *the one which has the* ***same fricative sound*** *as the word underlined in the sentences below.*

36. The farmer has left home.
    - **A.** phone
    - **B.** manner
    - **C.** arm
    - **D.** mat

37. The shirt is not for them.
    - **A.** cheque
    - **B.** same
    - **C.** passion
    - **D.** sieve

Choose from the options **A** *to* **D** *the word that contains the* ***same plosive sound*** *as the word underlined in the sentences below*

38. The witness claims they saw the thief scaling the wall.
    - **A.** fold
    - **B.** kite
    - **C.** broad
    - **D.** sole

39. My sister wanted to tag along with me for the festival.
    - **A.** thread
    - **B.** teeth
    - **C.** thigh
    - **D.** though

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Choose from the options **A** *to* **D**, *the word that contains the same diphthong sound as the underlined word.*

40. The captain told the players to <u>play</u> until the final whistle.

A. said
B. height
C. great
D. receive

END OF PAPER